

A-Tennis AI Coach

Auto Detect - Elite Coach

Unlock Your Backhand Power by Improving Your Contact Point

Player Olga | Jun 13 at 2:42 PM | Segment 0:00-0:48 | 0:48



Intermediate

C

NTRP-style 3.0-3.5

Confidence 92%

FASTEST IMPROVEMENT OPPORTUNITY

Contact Point

Estimated gain +7 to +9 level points. Projected score 73 if this fix shows up in the next clip.
Target 70 | Difficulty Focused | Time 4+ weeks

73
projected

SUMMARY

This is a solid two-handed backhand with an excellent initial unit turn. However, the key area for improvement is your contact point, which is currently too close to your body and slightly late. This jams your swing, preventing full arm extension and robbing you of power and topspin. By focusing on creating more space, you'll be able to extend through the ball, leading to a more powerful shot and a complete follow-through. Our action plan is designed to build this crucial habit of meeting the ball out in front.

FIX OF THE DAY

Create more space to make contact further in front of your body.

COACH SCORECARD

Strengths: Preparation, Balance, Racket Path / Face

Needs Work: Contact Point, Follow-through, Timing

Focus This Week: Contact Point

MECHANICS

Preparation

85

Elite Target: 90 | Confidence High | Estimated impact +2 to +3

You have a great unit turn, getting your shoulders and hips sideways early. This creates a solid foundation for the stroke by loading your upper body correctly. Continue to make this your first move as soon as you recognize the backhand.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Earlier preparation gives you more time, reduces rushed contact, and makes the swing easier to repeat.

Timing

55

Intermediate Target: 70 | Confidence High | Estimated impact +3 to +5

Your timing is slightly late, causing you to meet the ball beside your body rather than in front. This is likely a result of footwork or spacing. A late contact point forces you to use your arms exclusively, losing the power generated from your body's rotation.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Better timing keeps the strike zone predictable, which improves depth, pace, and control under pressure.

Contact Point

45

Intermediate Target: 70 | Confidence High | Estimated impact +7 to +9

Your contact point is the primary area to address. It's too close to your torso, forcing your arms to be significantly bent at impact. To generate leverage and power, you need to meet the ball further out in front, allowing for much greater extension.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Forward contact usually adds power and depth while giving you more time to recover for the next ball.

Kinetic Chain

60

Intermediate Target: 70 | Confidence High | Estimated impact +2 to +4

While your body rotation starts well, the energy transfer is cut short by the jammed contact point. The chain breaks when the arms can't extend, so the power from your legs and core doesn't fully translate into the racket head. Improving your spacing will fix this link.

WHY THIS MATTERS

A cleaner leg-to-hip-to-arm sequence creates easier power and reduces the need to muscle the ball.

Balance

70

Advanced Target: 80 | Confidence High | Estimated impact +2 to +4

Your balance is generally stable, but you appear to be leaning back slightly at contact. This is a common compensation for being too close to the ball. Focus on maintaining your weight on your front foot through the hit to improve stability and forward momentum.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Better balance keeps the racket face steadier and helps you recover without drifting after the shot.

Follow-through

50

Intermediate Target: 70 | Confidence High | Estimated impact +5 to +7

The follow-through is abbreviated and finishes low, a direct result of the jammed contact point. A full follow-through over your shoulder is not just for style; it ensures the racket accelerates through the ball and helps generate topspin. A better contact point will enable a better finish.

WHY THIS MATTERS

A complete follow-through lets the racket accelerate through contact and finish the shot naturally.

Racket Path / Face

65

Intermediate Target: 70 | Confidence High | Estimated impact +2 to +3

You correctly drop the racket head below the ball, creating a good low-to-high swing path for topspin. However, the path is cut short. By extending through the contact point, this path will become longer, allowing you to brush up the back of the ball more effectively for heavier spin.

WHY THIS MATTERS

A cleaner racket path and face angle make height, spin, and direction easier to control.

VISUAL CHECKPOINTS



PREPARATION

Excellent Preparation

Notice how your shoulders are turned completely sideways to the net. This is a textbook unit turn that properly prepares your body to rotate into the shot. This is a major strength, so continue to make this your first move on every backhand.



CONTACT

Jammed Contact Point

Here, at contact, your arms are bent and the racket is very close to your body. You are also leaning slightly away from the ball. The ideal contact point should be further out in front, allowing you to extend your arms for more leverage and power.



RECOVERY

Abbreviated Follow-Through

Your follow-through is short and finishes low instead of extending and wrapping high over your right shoulder. This is a direct symptom of the jammed contact point. A full, high finish is the natural result of extending through the ball and is crucial for generating effortless depth and topspin.

SWING PHASES

80

Ready

You have an athletic ready position with good posture, prepared for movement. Fix: Stay active on the balls of your feet and incorporate a split step just before the opponent hits.

90

Unit Turn

Your shoulders and hips turn together as one unit, getting you fully sideways early. Fix: No fix needed. This is a model preparation phase; keep it consistent.

75

Racket Drop

The racket head drops nicely below the ball, preparing for a topspin swing. Fix: As the racket drops, ensure your weight is beginning to transfer forward onto your front foot.

45

Contact

Contact is made too close to the body with bent arms and a slightly open stance. Fix: Use your footwork to create more space. Feel like you are reaching to meet the ball well in front of your lead hip.

50

Follow-through

The swing is cut short, with the racket finishing low and in front of your body. Fix: Think about extending your arms towards your target after contact, then let the momentum carry the racket high over your right shoulder.

60

Recovery

You hold the finish to watch the ball, but are a bit slow to start your recovery steps. Fix: After the follow-through is complete, immediately perform a crossover step to get back towards the center of the court.

ACTION PLAN

1

1. Main Focus: Spacing

For the next two weeks, make your single swing thought on every backhand 'meet the ball in front'. Judge every shot not by whether it went in, but by whether you achieved good spacing and extension.

2

2. Technical Drill: Shadow Swings and Feeds

Do 20 shadow swings focusing on extending your arms to an imaginary contact point far in front. Then, have a partner feed you 30 easy balls to your backhand, focusing only on footwork and spacing to replicate that extended contact point.

3

3. On-Court Practice: Cross-Court Rallies

Spend 15 minutes rallying cross-court with a partner. The goal is not to win the point, but to hit every backhand with proper spacing. Exaggerate how far in front you meet the ball. This will help groove the new muscle memory in a live-ball situation.

4

4. Retest and Verify

After two weeks of focused practice, film your backhand again from the same angle. Compare the new video to this one, looking specifically at the space between your elbow and your body at the contact point. You should see a noticeable increase in extension.

RECOMMENDED DRILL

Reach and Extend Backhand Drill: Place a cone or marker about two feet in front and one foot to the side of your ideal contact point. Have a partner feed you balls, and focus on making contact over the cone. This forces you to step into the shot and extend your arms, preventing the jammed swing. Feel your arms reaching away from your body as you swing from low to high.